3 Arab–Israeli Wars in 1956, 1967 and 1973

POINTS TO CONSIDER

When the state of Israel was created in 1948 it was immediately plunged into war with the surrounding Arab states. The new state survived its first war but, over the next 25 years, there were to be three more major conflicts between Israel and its Arab neighbours. This chapter examines the causes and consequences of each of those wars. Then, finally, it recounts how Egypt became the first Arab state to sign a peace treaty with Israel. These events are considered under the following headings:

- Egypt and the Suez crisis
- The Suez War 1956
- The causes of the Six-Day War 1967
- The Six-Day War and its results
- From war to peace: Yom Kippur to Camp David 1973–8

Key dates

1949		First Arab–Israeli war ended in defeat for Arabs
1952		King of Egypt overthrown by army officers
1954		Nasser became President of Egypt
1955	February	Israeli attack on Gaza
	September	Egypt announced Czech arms deal
1956	July	Nationalisation of Suez Canal
	October 29	Israeli forces invaded Egypt
	October 31	British and French bombed Egyptian airfields
	November 6	UN ceasefire and Anglo-French withdrawal from Egypt
1964		Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) established
1965		Fatah carried out its first raid on Israel
1966		Egypt signed a defence agreement with Syria
1967	April 7	Air fight between Israeli and Syrian planes
	May 15	Nasser moved Egyptian troops into Sinai